



DAS Standard

Encrypted USB Drive

No:
700-03

Effective:
April 29, 2025

Approved By:
Katrina Flory, Assistant Director/State CIO

I. Purpose

The purpose of this standard is to ensure that only Ohio Department of Administrative Services (DAS) Office of Information Technology (OIT) approved encrypted universal serial bus (USB) drives are used to store **Confidential Data** or **Personally Identifiable Information**. The requirements outlined in this standard will help DAS OIT technical teams ensure that encrypted USB drives are consistently implemented across the agency. The first occurrence of a defined term in the policy body outside of a title or heading is in bold, italic type, and is hyperlinked to the definition in Section IV.

II. Scope

This standard applies to the storage of Confidential Data on USB drives and represents the minimum acceptable criteria governing DAS encrypted USB drives.

III. Standard

- A. **Encryption Standard for DAS-managed encrypted USB drives:** DAS OIT approved encrypted USB drives shall meet the following requirements:
1. The encryption technology shall conform to Ohio IT Standard ITS-SEC- 01, "Data Encryption and Cryptography."
 2. The implementation and management of the drives shall be in accordance with Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14, "Data Encryption and Securing Confidential Data."

3. Each drive shall be configured with an independent **Administration Personal Identification Number (PIN)** for access. The administration PIN will be set and maintained by DAS IT Service (ITS).
4. **Users** shall set their own **User Access PIN** that will unlock the encrypted USB drive.
5. Encrypted USB drives shall prevent Users from setting PINs that contain consecutive numbers.
6. Encrypted USB drives shall be purchased and managed through DAS ITS.

B. Implementation

1. All new DAS encrypted USB drives shall be purchased and managed through DAS ITS.
2. Any existing USB drives that are used to store Confidential Data shall be turned into DAS IT Services and be replaced with a drive that meets the requirements outlined in this standard. DAS IT Services shall ensure that the data on the drive is securely handled in accordance with state and agency policies.

IV. Definitions

- A. Administration Personal Identification Number (PIN). This is a PIN associated with the encrypted USB drive that allows DAS OIT IT Services to manage User access.
- B. Confidential Data. This classification includes Data that is required to be protected by law or regulation, is intended for confidential use, and may not be copied or removed from an agency's operational control without authorized permission. This classification includes Data that, if compromised, may result in loss of life, serious injury, or other harm to an individual or group, or disruption to critical agency operations.
- C. Personally Identifiable Information. Information that can be used directly or in combination with other information to identify a particular individual. It includes:
 - a name, identifying number, symbol, or other identifier assigned to a person,
 - any information that describes anything about a person,
 - any information that indicates actions done by or to a person, and
 - any information that indicates that a person possesses certain personal characteristics.¹
- D. User. For the purposes of this policy, a User is defined as employees, contractors, temporary personnel and other agents of the state who administer and use state computer and telecommunications systems on behalf of the state.
- E. User Access Personal Identification Number (PIN). PINs associated with the general User account for the encrypted USB drive. These accounts are associated with individuals and have

¹ Based on Ohio Revised Code Section 1347.01 (E).

the ability to unlock the encrypted USB drive, but do not have the elevated privileges required to make changes to management parameters.

V. Authority

ORC 125.18

VI. Resources

Document Name	Location
Ohio IT Standard ITS-SEC-01 Data Encryption and Cryptography	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies
Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14 Data Encryption and Securing Confidential Data	https://das.ohio.gov/technology-and-strategy/policies/it-14

VII. Inquiries

For information regarding this standard, please contact:

Office of Information Security & Privacy
Office of Information Technology
Ohio Department of Administrative Services
30 East Broad Street, 39th Floor
Columbus, Ohio 43215

1-614-644-6860 | state.isp@das.ohio.gov

State of Ohio information security and privacy standards may be found online at:
<https://ohid.ohio.gov/wps/myportal/gov/myohio/my-resources/oisp/oisp-services/information-security-privacy-standards>

VIII. Revision History

This standard shall be reviewed no less than every two years and updated as needed.

Date	Description of Change
06/28/2017	Original Standard
12/04/2018	Updated the exception request language to align with the current procedure.

Date	Description of Change
05/27/2020	Updated standard template.
06/02/2021	Conducted routine maintenance review of citations and references.
04/29/2025	Replaced the term sensitive data, or sensitive information, with confidential data. Revised reference to Ohio Administrative Policy IT-14 to reflect the title change. Updated the template.